LINH TRAN
Tran Hoang Phuong Linh
Email: thphuonglinh.97@gmail.com
Website: https://tinaisha.github.io/TranLinh3.github.io/

EDUCATION

Ph.D.	Economics, McGill University, Canada, completed June 2026
B.A. (Honours)	Economics and Econometrics, University of Queensland, Australia, 2019

FIELDS OF SPECIALIZATION

Primary:	Econometrics and Machine Learning
Secondary:	Empirical macroeconomics and Central Banking

DISSERTATION

Essays on Central Bank Communications and Textual Analysis.
Committee: Prof. John W. Galbraith, Prof. Francisco Ruge-Murcia

RESEARCH PAPERS

"Central Bank Communication in Time of Crisis: Textual Complexity and Clarity Trade-off," Working Paper (Revised), 2026

Central banks may rationally adjust their communication strategies to balance clarity and flexibility, especially amid shifting economic conditions. Textual complexity can signal deliberate ambiguity, preserving policy maneuverability while still guiding expectations. This paper uses natural language tools to analyze policy statements from multiple central banks and their relationship to linguistic complexity, examining not only readability but also abstractness, informativeness, and disunity. We find that most dimensions of linguistic complexity increase during periods of low growth or economic stimulus, and abstract language is used more intensively during stimulation regardless of growth levels. By tracing these patterns, this study provides evidence that the degree of complexity of communications is the outcome of a rational choice made to balance competing central bank goals.

"Complexity in FOMC Communication: Drivers, Differences, and Market Reactions," Working Paper, 2026

This empirical paper studies the determinants and consequences of linguistic complexity in Federal Open Market Committee (FOMC) communication using a large corpus of policymaker speeches. First, do policymakers adjust their language in response to financial-market conditions before they speak? Complexity responds primarily to volatility-based indicators and trading volume—rather than to returns themselves. Policymakers simplify their language when equity-market volatility rises, but increase structural and syntactic complexity when uncertainty originates in Treasuries, gold, or volatility-linked assets. Second, do individual policymakers differ systematically in how they communicate? Speaker characteristics and topic choice explain most of the variation in complexity, with education, professional background, institutional role, and intellectual tradition all leaving distinct linguistic signatures. Third, does complexity influence market behaviour after the speech? Complexity predicts volatility and trading volume across equities, Treasuries, gold, and volatility indices, with short-lived intraday spikes but overall dampening effects at the daily horizon. Together, the results show a two-way interaction: market turbulence shapes the complexity of FOMC communication, and complexity in turn moderates market responses once information is absorbed.

"Deliberation and Policy Outcomes: Evidence from the FOMC," with Francisco Ruge-Murcia and Alessandro Riboni

Natural language processing is used to extract information from FOMC transcripts and construct quantitative text-based measures of policy stance, emotions, and collaboration. These

measures are inputs in[to] an econometric model of deliberation where members interact with one another across rounds of a meeting and over time across meetings. Evidence is reported that members learn from one another during within-meeting deliberation and exert influence across meetings. Although emotional tone has limited effect on policy stances and decisions, it has strong predictive power [on] for dissent behavior.

OTHER RESEARCH PAPERS

"Regulation Complexity Measurements: Methods and Patterns across Time and Industry", 2023, unpublished manuscript

"Applied Causal Inference using Identification Robust Confidence Sets Under Sparsity", 2019, Honours Thesis, School of Economics, The University of Queensland

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Econometrics (graduate), McGill University, Fall 2021– Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant, Quantitative Methods (graduate), McGill University, Fall 2021, Fall 2022 and Fall 2023

Teaching Assistant, Applied Cross-Sectional Methods (graduate), McGill University, Winter 2024

Teaching Assistant, Economic Statistics (undergraduate), McGill University, Fall 2024 – Winter 2025

Teaching Assistant, Introduction to Econometrics (undergraduate), University of Queensland, 2018–2019

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

ML Reproducibility Challenge, Prof. Siamak Ravanbakhsh, Fall 2021

Research Assistant, Prof. Renuka Mahadeva, University of Queensland, Jul-Oct 2018

Research Assistant, Working as a Casual SRN (Student Relations Network) Crew member, Sept-Nov 2018

CIREQ Lunch Seminar presenter, 2023-2025

Participated in online competitions (Kaggle), including forecasting, NLP, and applied econometrics tasks, 2018–2024

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Graduate Funding, McGill University Department of Economics

FitzGerald scholarship for Bachelor of Economics (Honour), 2019

Vietnam Undergraduate Scholarship at The School of Economics - The University of Queensland

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

2023-2025: CIREQ Lunch Seminar presenter, 2026: CIREQ Weekly PhD Student Research Workshop

LANGUAGES

English (fluent), Vietnamese (native), French (beginner)

COMPUTATIONAL SKILLS

Python (highly proficient), MATLAB, Stata (Proficient), R, EViews, HTML, C++

REFERENCES

Prof. John W Galbraith	McGill University	john.galbraith@mcgill.ca	+1 514 3985167
Prof. Francisco Ruge-Murcia	McGill University	francisco.ruge-murcia@mcgill.ca	+1 514 3986063
Prof. Alessandro Riboni	École Polytechnique	alessandro.riboni@gmail.com	+33 1 70266927